Local Disaster Management Authorities interaction

Purpose: To understand how local authorities prepare for and respond to earthquakes.

Interviewee: [: Mr Amit Khatri, deputy commissioner Gurugram Disaster Management Authority
Date: 28/06/2028

Location: DISTRICT DISASTER MANAGEMENT AUTHORITY, ROOM NO.208A IInd FLOOR MINI SECRETARIATE NEAR RAJIV CHOWK GURUGRAM-122001

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- **What is your department's role during an earthquake emergency?**

Ans. We Give information regarding earthquakes; we make people to understand the safety measures during earthquake situations. The department conducts **annual earthquake drills** in schools and public buildings. Coordination is done through a **central command center** with police, fire, and medical teams

- **How do you prepare for earthquakes in advance?**

Ans. **Drones** are deployed to assess damage in high-rise areas. Coordination is done through a **central command center** with police, fire, and medical teams. They use **mobile alert systems** and **walkie-talkies** for communication during emergencies.

- **Do you use any technology (like drones, sensors, or apps) during rescue operations?**

Ans. Yes, we do; believes **AI-based prediction tools** and **real-time data dashboards**, we use and technology can greatly improve future response. We use **mobile alert systems** and **walkie-talkies** for communication during emergencies.**Drones** are deployed to assess damage in high-rise areas.

- **What challenges do you face during earthquake emergencies?**

Ans. Major challenges include **traffic congestion**, **panic among citizens**, and **limited access to narrow lanes**.

- **How can schools and students contribute to earthquake preparedness?**

Ans. 1. Earthquake Drills & Safety Protocols

- Schools should conduct regular **mock drills** to teach students how to "Drop, Cover, and Hold On" during tremors.
- Teachers and staff must be trained in **evacuation procedures** and **first aid**.

2. Disaster Preparedness Clubs

- Students can form **Disaster Management Clubs** to spread awareness through posters, skits, and presentations.
- These clubs can organize **quiz competitions**, **safety exhibitions**, and **community outreach** programs.

3. Curriculum Integration

- Earthquake preparedness should be included in **Social Science and Science lessons**, helping students understand tectonic movements, fault lines, and safety measures.
- Creative assignments like **model-making**, **flowcharts**, and **role-plays** can make learning interactive.

4. Technology Use

- Students can use **mobile apps** like *MyShake* or *Google Earthquake Alerts* to understand how early warning systems work.
- Schools can invite experts to demonstrate **GIS mapping**, **seismic sensors**, or **VR-based earthquake simulations**.

5. Community Engagement

6. Safe Infrastructure

- Schools should ensure buildings are **earthquake-resistant** and follow the **National Building Code**.
- Emergency exits, assembly points, and signage must be clearly marked and accessible.